

The SCP Foundation Wiki is a collaborative speculative fiction website that presents itself as a welcoming, open community for writers and readers. However, a closer examination of its official documentation reveals a highly structured environment with strict rules, rigid procedures, and significant barriers to participation. The Foundation's mission, as stated in the "About" page, is framed as a noble effort to protect humanity from anomalous entities. The wiki presents itself as a collaborative space where anyone can contribute to the Foundation's goal of securing, containing, and protecting. Yet the practical reality of participating in the wiki is far more complex than the welcoming tone suggests. The membership process alone presents multiple hurdles. Prospective members must be at least 18 years old with no exceptions, submit a specific statement acknowledging AI restrictions, and adhere to strict username policies that prohibit names based on Foundation characters or staff positions. The application requires explicit acknowledgment that AI-generated content will result in permanent bans. These requirements create a high barrier to entry. The site rules are comprehensive and strictly enforced. Rule Zero, "Don't be a dick", serves as a broad foundation for staff discretion. The SCP Wikidot uses a rigid Object Class system to classify anomalies. Authors must use one of the approved classes: Safe, Euclid, Keter, Thaumiel, Apollyon, Archon, Argus, Cernunnos, Ticonderoga, Explained, Neutralized, Decommissioned, Pending, or Uncontained. Custom classes aren't allowed. Any article using a non-standard class will be rejected and deleted. Explained-class SCPs must use the -EX suffix (e.g., SCP-XXXX-EX). This isn't optional. The suffix is mandatory. Every Explained SCP on the wiki uses it. Omission of the suffix results in rejection. The disciplinary process follows a clear escalation path from warnings to permanent bans, with actions like plagiarism, harassment, and threats of legal action potentially resulting in immediate permanent bans. The rules are applied with significant staff authority and limited appeals. The deletion process demonstrates how easily contributions can be removed. Articles falling to a score of negative 10 trigger deletion procedures, and rule violations can result in immediate removal. Staff have broad authority to delete content, while the system encourages authors to self-delete failing works. This creates a "delete first" culture where articles are disposable. The criticism policy reveals expectations for feedback, requiring helpful, specific critique while discouraging personal attacks and vague responses. This promotes improvement but maintains staff oversight and enforcement. The Required Reading Hub centralizes essential guides, including writing policies, licensing information, and greenlight requirements. Authors must educate themselves through multiple guides before contributing. The site's licensing framework gives staff legal authority to act as rights

agents. Overall, the SCP Wikidot operates as a highly curated, strict environment. The gap between its welcoming rhetoric and its rigid, enforced rules creates tension for new and established contributors alike. The wiki may be more accurately described as a controlled creative platform rather than the open community it presents itself as. Participation requires compliance with multiple layers of rules, acceptance of significant staff authority, and understanding of deletion risks, making it a challenging environment for casual contributors.